THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 28, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

"10k Starship launches/year is just from Starbase Louisiana"

SpaceX told federal aviation regulators that it anticipates conducting 10,000 launches a year itself, and that the Federal Aviation Administration's air traffic control structure and processes, not rockets, are what stand in the way, TeslaNorth reported. The comments answered an FAA request for information on where to site new spaceports and how to give launches priority in U.S. airspace. The FAA's own notice forecast about 10,000 licensed launches and reentries a year by 2035; SpaceX put today's level at 182 licensed launches and 7 licensed reentries in 2025 (TeslaNorth).

"10k Starship launches/year is just from Starbase Louisiana," Elon Musk posted at 2:07 a.m. EDT Wednesday, quoting a summary of the filing. The planned Louisiana spaceport is designed for about 30 launches and reentries per day (Benzinga). To a user who wrote that SpaceX "rewrites aviation control software to launch more," Musk replied at 3:58 a.m.: "We address the limiting factor." None of the filings approves any launches.

I · SPACEX & STARLINK

Ship 42 runs all six engines

A full-duration static fire for Flight 15, United's chief on Starlink, and a compute deal Anthropic put at up to $120.5 billion.

10,000	661	$120.5B
launches a year SpaceX told the FAA it anticipates	United jets with Starlink, adding about three a day	most Anthropic could pay SpaceX for compute through 2029

"Starship Flight 15: Ship 42 conducts a six-engine static fire test," NASASpaceflight posted at 5:46 p.m. EDT Tuesday, adding a minute later: "Full duration" (post). The ship had run a single-engine static fire on Monday. It ran its six engines for roughly 60 seconds on the static fire stand at SpaceX's Massey Outpost, according to Next Spaceflight. Ship 43 and Booster 23 are slated for Flight 16, the first Starship launch from LC-39A in Florida, NASASpaceflight posted early Wednesday.

BY THE NUMBERS

182	FAA-licensed SpaceX launches in 2025, plus 7 reentries (TeslaNorth)
~30	launches and reentries a day planned for Starbase Louisiana (Benzinga)
222	Cybercabs registered in Texas in the last week (Sawyer Merritt)



A Super Heavy booster beside the launch tower at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024.

PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

United's "biggest competitive advantage"

United Airlines is adding Starlink to about three aircraft a day and already has it on 661 jets, chief executive Scott Kirby said on the Cheeky Pint podcast released Tuesday, TeslaNorth reported; full-fleet coverage is due by the end of 2027. "I think it's the biggest competitive advantage. And it's temporary,"

Kirby said, Teslarati reported. "Everybody eventually is going to have high speed low earth orbit internet connectivity."

Anthropic's compute bill

Anthropic could pay SpaceX up to $120.5 billion for compute through 2029, the AI lab disclosed in its S-1 filing on Monday, Yahoo Finance reported. Monthly payments would rise to about $3.1 billion once all contracted capacity is delivered, which Anthropic expects in December 2026; the figure is a maximum, and either side can terminate on 90 days' notice after initial periods that end in January and March 2027.

The FCC votes Thursday

At its open meeting at 10:30 a.m. EDT Thursday, the Federal Communications Commission will consider making an additional 482 megahertz of spectrum available for Supplemental Coverage from Space, the satellite-to-phone service, according to the FCC agenda. AT&T, Verizon and T-Mobile have asked the FCC to drop two of the proposed bands, Capacity reported.

Report: ad bidder targeted Starlink users

Researchers at TrendAI, a unit of Trend Micro, concluded that Israeli ad-tech company Discover-Tech was the No. 1 bidder on Starlink traffic in more than 100 countries, likely to geolocate or otherwise surveil users, Reuters reported Tuesday, citing six people familiar with the matter. TrendAI assessed the activity as "targeting and tracking infrastructure rather than a commercial advertising operation." SpaceX and Discover-Tech did not respond to requests for comment (Reuters).

> **QUICK HIT**
> **"Starlink."** That was Musk's whole post at 2:58 a.m. EDT Wednesday, quoting an account of Karina, 24, who faced a high-risk pregnancy in rural Colombia, where reaching town could take two days on horseback, until a visiting doctor brought a portable Starlink.

II · TESLA & AUTONOMY

Cybercabs pass Model Ys in Texas

Tesla's purpose-built robotaxi now leads its authorized Texas fleet, Musk promised Florida beaches, and the stock rose 4%.

544 Cybercabs among 1,051 authorized Texas Robotaxi vehicles	**573** Cybercabs registered to date, per Texas DMV data	**+4.04%** TSLA on Tuesday, to $407.46

The Cybercab has become the majority vehicle in Tesla's authorized Robotaxi fleet in Texas for the first time, Yahoo Finance reported on Tuesday, citing Texas Department of Motor Vehicles data: of 1,051 authorized vehicles, 544 are Cybercabs and 507 are Model Ys. The data show which vehicles are authorized, not whether they are carrying riders. Tesla then registered another 29 Cybercabs, for 573 to date and 222 in the last week, Sawyer Merritt posted at 10:34 p.m. EDT Tuesday.

Replying early Tuesday to a post saying "Waymo's about to learn an important lesson about exponential curves," Musk wrote at 1:05 a.m. EDT: "Log curve in blue, exponential in red." Waymo said on Tuesday it is adding nearly 250 square miles across five metro areas over the next week (Waymo).

"Coming soon" to the beaches

"They need to have the Tampa and Miami ones include the beaches!" Florida Governor Ron DeSantis wrote at 10:43 p.m. EDT Monday about Tesla's Robotaxi zones. Musk replied at 10:35 a.m. Tuesday: "Coming soon." Robotaxi's Tampa zone covers 24 square miles and Miami's 31, Merritt posted on Monday.



A Tesla Cybercab on Harrison Street in San Francisco on June 12, 2026.
PHOTO: 9YZ / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0 (CROPPED)

> **QUICK HIT**
> **Powershare for all.** "Every new Tesla can now power your tools or gadgets via Powershare," Tesla North America posted at 4:07 p.m. EDT Tuesday, adding that it is "Available in US & Mexico with Mobile Connector and Outlet Adapter" (post).

A world champion in a Cybercab

Damon Hill, the 1996 Formula 1 world champion, took a solo Cybercab ride in Austin. "F1 World Champion tries Cybercab," the Robotaxi account posted at 8:51 p.m. EDT Tuesday. During the ride Hill asks Grok what happened at the U.S. Grand Prix and has it play race highlights, TeslaNorth reported.

Seoul police book 80 owners

Seoul police have booked 80 people for activating FSD (Supervised) with unauthorized devices on China-built Teslas and seized 21 of the devices, Korea JoongAng Daily reported on Tuesday. In Korea the software is legal only on U.S.-built models such as the Model S, Model X and Cybertruck; the charges carry up to two years in prison or a fine of up to 20 million won ($15,000).

Tesla rises 4%

Tesla shares closed Tuesday at $407.46, up 4.04%, on volume 23% above their 30-session average, according to Yahoo Finance data. SpaceX's SPCX rose 1.14% to $148.58 (Yahoo Finance).

> **QUICK HIT**
> **"Like my old Roadster."** Tesla posted "What goes up must come down" at 12:49 p.m. EDT Tuesday. Musk replied at 1:25 p.m.: "Unless you reach escape velocity, like my old Roadster."

III · X & GROK

"Major fail, will get fixed pronto"

Musk answered a complaint about paying for Grok Bot, shared its new features and quote-posted users' praise.

"Key product feedback for team @bot and @elonmusk. I hit the paywall on grokbot. There are so many steps to pay that ive failed 2x. Are you tracking failed pay attempts?" Zynga founder Mark Pincus posted at 1:32 p.m. EDT Tuesday, adding that the product should "give some limited free use daily." Musk replied at 2:19 p.m.: "Major fail, will get fixed pronto. Thanks for the feedback."

New features

At 12:31 p.m. Musk shared a video of new Grok Bot features posted by @mattyp, whose chapter list includes Pages, Vault, 1Password and Apple integrations, video creation, new bot characters and X Spaces. At 2:03 a.m. EDT Wednesday he quote-posted the Grok Imagine team's announcement that its prompting guide is live, with the words "Grok Imagine" (post).

"Like hiring an awesome employee"

Overnight he quote-posted users' praise. Investor Gavin Baker, in a clip, calls Grok Bot "the most impactful AI product to me and to the firm that we've had yet" ("Grok @Bot rocks," Musk wrote). Analyst Pierre Ferragu posted that his Grok Bot "is promoted to fully-fledged team member" ("Hire Grok @Bot, you won't regret it," post). Quoting a post by Coinbase chief executive Brian Armstrong at 2:08 a.m., he wrote: "Grok @Bot is like hiring an awesome employee."

> **QUICK HIT**
> **A truce in Oleshky.** "Good," Musk wrote at 1:10 p.m. EDT Tuesday, quoting First Lady Melania Trump's announcement that a ceasefire she brokered had begun. The humanitarian truce covers the Russian-occupied town of Oleshky in Ukraine's Kherson region, took effect at 3 a.m. local time Tuesday (9 p.m. EDT Monday) and appeared to be holding hours later, NBC News reported.

Takeaways

1. SpaceX told the FAA it anticipates 10,000 launches a year; Musk said that is "just from Starbase Louisiana."
2. Ship 42 completed a full-duration six-engine static fire for Flight 15.
3. Cybercabs now outnumber Model Ys in Tesla's authorized Texas Robotaxi fleet, 544 to 507.
4. Musk said Robotaxi service on Florida's Tampa and Miami beaches is "Coming soon."
5. Musk called Grok Bot's payment flow a "Major fail" and promised a quick fix.
6. TSLA rose 4.04% to $407.46; SPCX gained 1.14%.

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @xdNiBoR, @markusdd5, @NASASpaceflight, @cb_doge, @SawyerMerritt, @Not_the_Bee, @RonDeSantis, @robotaxi, @Tesla, @markpinc, @mattyp, @imagine, @firesidealpha, @p_ferragu, @brian_armstrong, @MELANIATRUMP and @tesla_na.

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